
Who will win the 2026 Ballon d'Or? Mbappe? Kane? Rodri?

Published by

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Estimated reading time

3 min

Added on

2026-08-10

Address

<https://www.football365.com/news/who-will-win-the-2026-ballon-dor-yamal-the-runaway-early-favourite>

Who will win the 2026 Ballon d'Or? Mbappe? Kane? Rodri?

The Ballon d'Or was always going to be intrinsically linked with the World Cup so that's why Rodri has emerged as one of the favourites.

We all pretend that winning the Champions League will be a factor but really, it's more about the World Cup.

Ranking comes via Oddschecker odds.

Who are the favourites to win the 2026 Ballon d'Or?

10) Erling Haaland (Man City/Norway)

Let's face it, if he had somehow dragged Norway to an unlikely World Cup win, he would have absolutely deserved it.

9) Fabian Ruiz (PSG/Spain)

Team success is doing some heavy lifting. Fabian is a fantastic player, but, come on...

7=) Michael Olise (Bayern Munich/France)

We thought it was a left-field choice in December but he ended the season brilliantly with Bayern Munich. This looked really quite likely until France were dumped out of the World Cup by Spain.

7=) Jude Bellingham (Real Madrid/England)

Won nothing for Real Madrid in 2026 and then won nothing for England in 2026, with his World Cup ending with a whimper against Argentina.

6) Ousmane Dembele (PSG/France)

The 2025 Ballon winner had a season punctuated by injury but he somehow still scored 20 goals for PSG, including seven in the knockout stages of the Champions League and one in the final. But he probably needed France to win the World Cup and that did not happen.

5) Lionel Messi (Inter Miami/Argentina)

It was definitely on like Donkey Kong if Argentina won the World Cup but Lionel Messi failed to have an impact in the final as Argentina fell to Spain. Football can be oddly sentimental but not that sentimental.

4) Kylian Mbappe (Real Madrid/France)

He presumably thought that he would dominate the post-Messi/Ronaldo era, but he is yet to claim his first Ballon d'Or. Two years after arriving at Real Madrid, he is also yet to claim a proper trophy

in Madrid colours. It looked like he might dominate the World Cup enough to take home this gong too, but he was poor with the rest of the France side v Spain.

3) Rodri (Man City/Spain)

Didn't even appear in the top 10 until Spain beat France in the World Cup semi-final and we all remembered that Rodri is the best central midfielder in the world. Repeated the trick against Argentina in the final and was awarded the Golden Ball. It really doesn't matter that Man City *only* won a couple of trophies in 2026. [He's completed football.](#)

2) Lamine Yamal (Barcelona/Spain)

"Lamine Yamal is the best player in the world by far. It's not just because he's my son, but because he's the best player in the world."

That might be so, Lamine Yamal's dad, but that's not exactly how this works. On paper he won rather a lot in 2026 – including the World Cup – but injury prevented him from really flying in that World Cup.

1) Harry Kane (Bayern Munich/England)

Can lay claim to being the most consistent goalscorer in world football over the last decade and yet he has never ranked higher than 10th in the Ballon d'Or. Does pure goalscoring butter no parsnips? He's the [top scorer of 2026](#) so far by an absolute mile, did he need a World Cup win to cement his case? Maybe. Now the dust has settled, Kane is the odds-on favourite with several bookmakers.

READ: [16 Conclusions on the World Cup final: abysmal Argentina, pathetic Fernandez, brilliant Spain, weird HT show](#)

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